10. Hiuen Tsiang, Samuel Beal (translator), *Si Yu Ki: Buddhist Records of the Western World*, Kegan Paul, Trench, Trubner & Co. Ltd., 1906, pp. 44–45.
11. Sen, Sudipta, *Ganga: The Many Pasts of a River,* Gurgaon, Viking, 2019, p. 251.
12. Historian Sudipta Sen writes that during the Delhi Sultanate period, many grand new temples were built in Varanasi, such as Vishweshwar Temple during the reign of Iltutmish, the temple of Padmeshwar during the reign of Alauddin Khalji, the temple of Manikarnikeshwar during the Tughluq rule and more. See Sen, Sudipta, *Ganga: The Many Pasts of a River,* Gurgaon, Viking, 2019, p. 266.
13. Parry, Jonathan P., *Death in Banaras*, Cambridge University Press, 1994, pp. 39–40.
14. Eaton, Richard M., 'Temple Desecration and Indo-Muslim States', *Journal of Islamic Studies*, 11:3, pp. 283–319 © Oxford Centre for Islamic Studies 2000.
15. Ibid.
16. For instance, Aurangzeb had issued a farman in 1659 to protect all Hindu temples and their staff, but when political circumstances changed ten years later, he ordered Varanasi's Bindu Madhav and Vishwanath temples destroyed, replacing them with Alamgiri and Gyanvapi mosques. In particular, Vishwanath temple, 'built by Todar Mal, Akbar's finance minister, was torn down to punish Hindus who were supporting Aurangzeb's arch enemy, the Maratha Shivaji'. See: Asher, Catherine B., Cynthia Talbot, *India before Europe*, Cambridge University Press, 2006, p. 231.
17. Daniyal, Shoaib, 'Forgotten Indian History: The Shoaib Brutal Maratha Invasions of Bengal', Scroll.in, December 21, 2015.
18. Implicit and explicit material incentives for conversion were much preferred. Aurangzeb often 'gave out robes of honor, cash gifts, and promotions to converts'. Richards, John F., *The New Cambridge History of India: The Mughal Empire*, CUP, 1993.
19. Relatively few upper-caste Hindus converted, suggesting that more than access to jobs, escaping caste was a bigger motivator for conversion—the same desire that later fuelled mass conversions to Sikhism, Christianity and Navayana Buddhism.